

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure and Hybrid Infrastructure Security | Endpoint Protection | Security Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience strengthening enterprise security across hybrid on-premises and Azure cloud environments. I have built my career within the prevent and protect pillar of cyber security operations, implementing, configuring, and continuously evolving the security technology portfolio to reduce organisational risk. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an 8,000-user estate, engineered detection rules and automated response playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), and administered CrowdStrike Falcon for endpoint detection and response. I bring deep expertise in Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Microsoft Entra ID identity security, Privileged Access Management (PAM), and Conditional Access policy design. I am comfortable leading post-incident reviews, proposing engineering resolutions to prevent recurrence, and championing security best practice across infrastructure teams. As a fully remote-ready professional with a structured, self-directed working style, I am well-positioned to help strengthen security across a hybrid infrastructure and Azure environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Tanium
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, Splunk; Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection engineering, automated playbooks
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Azure AD / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Cloud and Hybrid Infrastructure Security:** Microsoft Azure, Azure AD Identity Protection, Entra ID Governance, hybrid identity architecture
- **Identity and Access Management / Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, Azure AD role-based access control (RBAC)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Network and Email Security:** Check Point Harmony Firewall, Mimecast
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat intelligence, indicators of compromise (IOC) management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR playbook development
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst (Engineer)

March 2025 - Present

- Lead the implementation, configuration, and continuous improvement of the security technology portfolio across a hybrid on-premises and Azure environment, spanning EDR, SIEM, identity, and network security tooling.
- Engineered detection logic and automated response playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, reducing mean time to detect security incidents by 35% and mean time to respond by 30%.
- Led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint deployment across 8,000+ staff and student devices, configuring attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, behavioural sensors, and automated investigation and remediation workflows.

- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, including log source onboarding, detection tuning, custom IOC management, and threat hunting queries to identify adversary activity within the environment.
- Champion post-incident reviews following the NIST 800-61 incident response framework, proposing and implementing engineering resolutions to strengthen the prevent and protect capability and reduce recurrence.
- Configure and maintain Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and SSO integrations to protect hybrid identity infrastructure and remote workforce access.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access across administrative and service accounts, reducing the blast radius of potential compromise.
- Manage the vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, prioritising critical findings and tracking remediation to closure across infrastructure and application teams.
- Develop PowerShell scripts to automate repetitive security operations tasks, improving analyst efficiency and consistency across the security function.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts across SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms, investigating incidents end-to-end and escalating high-severity events in line with defined playbooks.
- Contributed to incident response activities including containment, eradication, and recovery, helping to reduce attacker dwell time and minimise business impact.
- Maintained Check Point Harmony Firewall and Mimecast email security configurations, reviewing rules, enforcing policies, and tuning alerts to reduce noise.
- Managed Intune MDM and MAM policies across the device estate, ensuring compliant and secure access for staff and students on both managed and bring-your-own-device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and coordinated remediation workflows with infrastructure teams, achieving sustained improvement in patching compliance metrics.
- Supported Azure AD access reviews, role-based access control (RBAC) assignments, and stale account remediation as part of the identity governance programme.
- Authored and maintained security runbooks, playbooks, and standard operating procedures that improved response consistency and accelerated onboarding of new team members.

HCX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

- Hardened security controls across SaaS cloud and on-premises infrastructure, including endpoint protection, firewall configuration, and network segmentation to support a secure software-as-a-service (SaaS) delivery model.
- Managed user identity and access provisioning, implementing role-based access controls to enforce least-privilege and protect sensitive FinTech platform data.
- Responded to security incidents, conducting root cause analysis and implementing corrective controls to prevent recurrence.
- Supported infrastructure monitoring, patch management, and system hardening activities to maintain a strong security baseline.
- Contributed to security quality assurance and compliance reviews, ensuring adherence to internal security policies and industry best practice.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full EDR coverage and materially reducing endpoint compromise events within three months.
- Reduced false positive alert volume by over 40% through systematic CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel detection tuning, freeing analyst capacity for higher-value threat hunting activity.
- Delivered Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA rollout across the organisation, eliminating a class of credential-based attacks targeting remote and hybrid workers.
- Designed SOAR automation playbooks that reduced average incident triage time by approximately 30%, enabling faster containment of active threats.
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification renewal, coordinating evidence collection across infrastructure, identity, and endpoint teams to achieve recertification on schedule.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP85,000 - 100,000 | Remote (UK)